

Low Rider -- War

Why Can't We Be Friends?, 1975. 106 BPM, est.

B.B. Dickerson's bass line is the entire song -- that descending riff has to sit warm, round, and laid-back, not punchy or aggressive. This is a muted, almost palm-muted P-bass sound, not a bright modern tone.

GP-5 only, P/J bass, no pedalboard.

AMP: Classic Bass (Ampeg SVT) + CAB: Apg115 IR (User IR 1)

SVT is still the right amp family for this era, but Low Rider wants the rounder, boxier vintage voice of a 1x15 rather than an 8x10 stack -- Apg115 (Ampeg Heritage B-15) has a prominent peak around 100Hz that adds girth without the more modern, aggressive top end of the 810. Same suggested AMP pairing as the 810 (same Ampeg family), just a darker, girthier cab choice to match the laid-back part.

- Gain: 30 -- clean. This tone never breaks up; the amp just needs to sound warm and full.
- Bass: 65 -- deep, full low end, the foundation of the riff.
- Middle: 45, MidFreq: 450Hz -- pulled back from a typical funk-snap 800Hz setting. Low Rider isn't a percussive pop tone, it's smooth and rounded.
- Treble: 35 -- dark on purpose, close to a muted/flatwound feel even on the roundwound P/J.
- VOL: 65.
- CAB VOL: 60.

Module chain

NR -- Gate, always on.

THRE: 15. Very light -- clean, low-gain tone doesn't pick up much noise, just enough to tidy up the rests between phrases of the riff.

PRE -- COMP (Ross Compressor), always on.

Sustain: 45, VOL: 60.

Lighter squash than a percussive funk patch -- Low Rider's feel is loose and behind-the-beat, not tightly gated. Just enough compression to even out the riff's repeats without killing the laid-back dynamics.

DST -- Bass OD, on CTL.

Gain: 22, Blend: 45, VOL: 62, Bass: 50, Treble: 45.

Off for the main groove -- clean SVT tone through the whole verse riff.

On for the instrumental hook/outro breakdown section, where the band opens up -- a light push adds a bit more weight and presence without turning the tone aggressive.

AMP -- Classic Bass, always on. Gain 30, Bass 65, Middle 45, MidFreq 450Hz, Treble 35, VOL 65.

CAB -- User IR 1 (Apg115), always on. VOL 60.

EQ -- Bass EQ 2, always on.

50Hz: +4, 120Hz: +3, 400Hz: +2, 800Hz: -3, 4.5kHz: -4, VOL: 50.

Low end reinforced and warmed through 50Hz-400Hz, then rolled off through 800Hz and 4.5kHz -- that's the muted, rounded top end this riff needs. No funk snap, no string zing.

MOD -- off. No modulation -- this tone is about weight and roundness, not movement.

DLY -- off. Straight through, no delay -- the riff repeats on its own, doesn't need help.

RVB -- Room, on CTL.

Mix: 15, Decay: 22, Trail: off.

Off for the main groove -- dry, right on top of the beat, same as the record's tight low end.

On alongside the OD push for the instrumental hook -- a touch of room air to open the tone up when the band stretches out.

CTL footswitch

Two modules on CTL: DST (Bass OD) and RVB (Room).

- **CTL off** -- main verse/riff groove. Clean, warm, dark SVT tone through the B-15-style 1x15, dry and laid-back. This is the resting state the patch loads into.
- **CTL on** -- instrumental hook/outro breakdown. Light OD push plus a touch of room, same amp tone underneath, a bit more weight and size for the open section.

Engage CTL for the instrumental/outro stretch, back off for the main verse riff.